

Groups exist both online and offline. The online groups make use of web based dashboard to interact with users. In offline groups, you will communicate with fellow members physically.

## Newsgroups

The whole concept of groups started with Newsgroups. They are basically discussion groups where users post queries. There were newsgroups for each and every topics, subjects and technologies. Newsgroups were initially



Newsgroups are the best places for online consultations

started by a group of students of Duke University in 1979 with the launch of a Unix group. The students thought of a need to start a platform for interaction. Usenet was originated after this development to enable students and users to read and respond to messages.

### The Face of Usenet Newsgroups

Newsgroups were popular prior to the rapid emergence of the Internet. According to reports, there were around 20,000 active newsgroups around 1983. Microsoft newsgroups were famous during the year 2000. Programmers started to make use of newsgroups to find solution to their daily problems. An interesting fact about newsgroups is that you will get an opportunity to communicate with people who are more or less involved with the same line of topic.

Stanford University provides free access to Usenet newsgroup for all classes. Newsgroups hosted by University of Waterloo can be accessed via [news.uwaterloo.ca](http://news.uwaterloo.ca). Join one relevant for your course.

In order to read and reply to messages posted under a newsgroup, you need to download newsreader. Microsoft Outlook Express (Currently deprecated) was once a favourite tool for all users, who actively participate in